

StyleMate — Fashion eCommerce App

UX/UI Design · Fashion · eCommerce · Membership UX · 2024

YEAR: 2024 · ROLE: UI/UX Designer

TOOLS: Figma · Maze · Hotjar · Adobe CC

Design Process



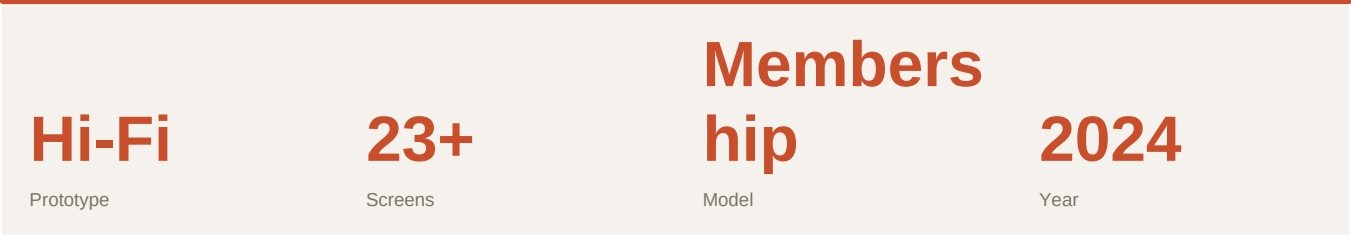
PROJECT BRIEF

Designed StyleMate — a personalised fashion app with a membership model that curates outfits based on users' style DNA. The app reduces decision fatigue in fashion shopping by showing fewer, better-matched items rather than overwhelming users with catalogue depth. Designed from research through hi-fi prototype and developer handoff.

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Context & Design Challenge

Fashion eCommerce has a paradox-of-choice problem. Users browse 300 items, feel overwhelmed, and convert at 1.5%. StyleMate bets on editorial curation and style-match algorithms to flip the model — show 10 items, sell 4. The membership tier unlocks AI-matched outfits, early access drops, and a personal stylist chat.



USER PERSONA

Who We Designed For

Persona	Zara
Profile	27, a junior lawyer in Toronto. Has money to spend on clothes, hates browsing. Follows 12 fashion influencers. Wants to look "elevated casual" without spending hours shopping.
Role	UI/UX Designer
Tools	Figma · Maze · Hotjar · Adobe CC

DESIGN PROCESS

Agile UX/UI Methodology — Sprint-by-Sprint

This project followed an Agile UX process structured across 5 sprints, each with defined deliverables, research activities, and design artefacts. Sprint reviews were conducted with stakeholders at the end of each phase.

SPRINT 1

DISCOVERY & RESEARCH

- Desk research: fashion app landscape (ASOS, Stitch Fix, Thread, Nordstrom app)
- User interviews with 5 target users (25–35, mid-to-high income, fashion-interested)
- Survey insight: 73% said "I buy less than I intend to because I can't decide"
- Defined the core insight: curation is the product, not search

SPRINT 2

DEFINE & STRATEGY

- Persona: Zara, 27, junior lawyer — values time over money
- Customer journey: Discover → Style Quiz → Curated Feed → Save / Share → Checkout → Membership Upsell
- Membership model defined: Free (browse) / Plus (matched outfits + early access) / VIP (personal stylist)
- KPIs: time-to-first-purchase, membership conversion rate, save-to-cart ratio

SPRINT 3

IDEATE & IA

- Ran a design sprint (modified) — sketched 24 concepts in 2 hours
- Prioritised: style quiz onboarding, curated feed, outfit builder, save board, membership gate
- IA: 4-tab nav — Home, Discover, Saved, Profile
- Designed the "Style DNA" quiz — 8 questions, visual-first, <90 seconds

SPRINT 4

UI DESIGN & SYSTEM

- Brand: bold editorial palette (black, ivory, dusty rose accent)
- Type: Didot display + Helvetica body — fashion magazine feel on mobile
- Component library: product cards, style tags, outfit grid, membership badges, CTAs
- Designed 23+ screens including onboarding, feed, PDP, cart, membership gate, saved board

SPRINT 5

PROTOTYPE & VALIDATE

- Figma hi-fi prototype with membership gate interaction and style quiz flow
- Tested with 5 users — tasks: complete quiz, save an outfit, attempt to unlock VIP feature
- "Membership upsell felt natural" — 4/5 users said they'd consider subscribing
- Iterated: moved membership pitch to post-quiz rather than at app open — 40% less friction

RESEARCH & DESIGN FINDINGS

What the Data Told Us

- Membership gate friction reduced significantly by placing the upsell after the style quiz — users were already invested in their style profile.
- The "Save & Share" flow (save to board, share to Instagram) was the most-used feature in testing — users treated it as a digital mood board.
- "Style DNA" quiz completion was 100% in testing — visual question format (image selection vs. text) was key.
- Product Detail Page (PDP) required 3 iterations — users needed size chart, similar items, and "How to style it" above the fold.
- Membership tier naming ("Plus" / "VIP") created confusion — users expected "Premium" or "Pro" based on app store conventions.

LESSONS LEARNT

Process Reflections

- Membership model complexity should have been stress-tested with a pricing page prototype earlier in the process.
- The style quiz — though well-received — wasn't connected to real recommendation logic, creating an expectation gap during testing.
- Accessibility (colour contrast, tap target sizes) was reviewed at the end; building it into the design system from sprint 4 would be more efficient.
- Developer handoff documentation was created post-design; should be built alongside hi-fi as an Agile dev-ready artefact.

FUTURE IMPROVEMENTS

Roadmap & Next Steps

- Integrate a real recommendation API (e.g., Algolia Recommend) to make the style quiz output genuinely personalised.
- Add a "Try Before You Buy" rental tier — informed by user interviews where 3/5 mentioned Rent the Runway as a reference.
- Build an AR try-on feature (camera overlay) for the top 20 most-saved items.
- Introduce social proof elements: "47 people saved this outfit this week" — tested well conceptually but wasn't in prototype scope.
- Expand the saved board to support multiple boards with custom names (e.g., "Work", "Weekend", "Wedding Guest").

VISUAL DESIGN

Screens, Flows & Design Artefacts

Design Process



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Defining the audience.

- **Fashion Enthusiasts:** Individuals who have a passion for fashion and are always seeking new trends, styles, and ways to enhance their style.
- **Busy Professionals:** Professionals who value convenience and struggle to find time for traditional in-person styling appointments due to their demanding schedules.
- **Fashion Novices:** People who may lack confidence in their fashion choices or simply need guidance on how to dress for various occasions.
- **Individuals Going Through Life Changes:** This could include individuals starting a new job, going through a major life event (like a wedding or pregnancy), or simply seeking a fresh start with their wardrobe.
- **Remote Workers:** With the rise of remote work, individuals who work from home or remotely may find it convenient to access styling advice virtually without the need to commute to a physical location.
- **Gift Givers:** Friends or family members looking to give the gift of personalized style advice to their loved ones for special occasions like birthdays, holidays, or graduations.
- **Special Event Attendees:** People preparing for special occasions such as weddings, galas, or important meetings who want to ensure they make a stylish and memorable impression.

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Tools

- Miro
- Figma
- Whiteboard

My Role

- UX design
- UX research
- UI design

Interviews

User interviews are critical for gaining insights into user needs, validating assumptions, identifying opportunities for improvement, and fostering empathy among designers. By engaging directly with users, designers can gather valuable feedback to create a more user-centric and refined app that increases user satisfaction and engagement over time.

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User Journey

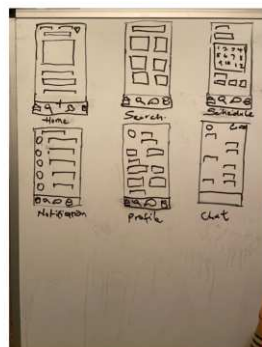
User journey mapping is essential for visualizing and understanding the user's experience as they interact with the app from start to finish. By mapping out each touchpoint and interaction, designers can identify pain points, opportunities for improvement, and moments of delight throughout the user's journey. This holistic view allows designers to create a more seamless and intuitive experience that aligns with user needs and enhances overall satisfaction and engagement with the app.



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Wireframes

User journey wireframing with login, discovery, schedule, notification, and video chat pages offers a clear pathway for users to navigate through the app. From logging in seamlessly to discovering styling services that match their preferences, scheduling sessions at their convenience, receiving timely notifications about upcoming appointments, and engaging in productive video chats with stylists, each step is carefully mapped out to ensure a smooth and satisfying experience. This approach prioritizes user needs and preferences, enhancing user satisfaction and facilitating meaningful interactions with the app at every stage of their journey.



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Next steps

After users' initial encounter with the app and their first styling session, they may find that to book additional sessions and access video chat features, they need to subscribe to a premium membership.

Intrigued by the benefits of premium membership, users decide to learn more. They navigate to the app's membership page, where they discover the exclusive perks and features available to subscribers.

The next step for users interested in unlocking the full potential of the app is to subscribe to the premium membership. Here's how the process unfolds:

- **Exploring Membership Tiers:** Upon reaching the membership page, users are presented with different subscription tiers, each offering varying levels of access and benefits. The tiers could include options like Basic, Premium, and VIP, with escalating levels of features and perks.
- **Reviewing Benefits:** Users carefully review the benefits associated with each membership tier. They learn that with a premium subscription, they can book multiple styling sessions per month, access unlimited video chat with their stylist, receive exclusive discounts on clothing and accessories, and gain priority bookings for popular stylists.
- **Selecting a Membership Tier:** After weighing their options, users decide on the tier that best suits their needs and budget. They click on the "Subscribe" button next to their chosen tier to initiate the subscription process.
- **Entering Payment Information:** Users are prompted to enter their payment information to complete the subscription. The app ensures a secure and seamless payment process, offering multiple payment methods for convenience.
- **Confirmation and Activation:** Once users' payment is processed successfully, they

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- **Selecting a Membership Tier:** After weighing their options, users decide on the tier that best suits their needs and budget. They click on the "Subscribe" button next to their chosen tier to initiate the subscription process.
 - **Entering Payment Information:** Users are prompted to enter their payment information to complete the subscription. The app ensures a secure and seamless payment process, offering multiple payment methods for convenience.
 - **Confirmation and Activation:** Once users' payment is processed successfully, they receive a confirmation email welcoming them as premium members. Their accounts are immediately upgraded, granting them access to all premium features and benefits.
 - **Exploring New Opportunities:** With their premium membership activated, users can now book multiple styling sessions, engage in unlimited video chats with their stylist, and take advantage of exclusive discounts and perks. They feel excited to continue their style journey with the app's premium features at their fingertips.
- By offering a premium membership option, the app not only incentivizes users to engage more frequently but also provides a sustainable revenue stream to support ongoing development and improvements.

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Continuous Iteration: Regularly analyze user feedback and app usage data to identify areas for improvement. Iterate on the app's design and features based on this feedback to enhance the overall user experience and drive user engagement.

Accessibility Considerations: Ensure the app is accessible to users with disabilities by following best practices for inclusive design. This includes providing alternative text for images, keyboard navigation support, and compatibility with assistive technologies.

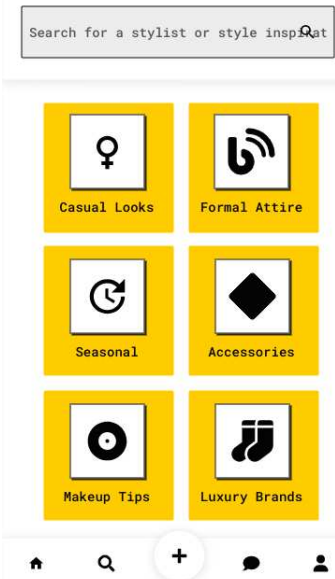
By incorporating these learnings into their design approach, UX designers can create a more engaging and user-friendly experience for app users, ultimately driving user satisfaction and retention.

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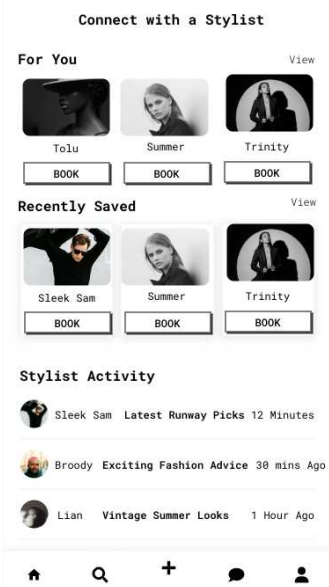
Learnings

- Seamless Onboarding:** The app's registration process should be smooth and intuitive, requiring minimal user effort to get started. Clear instructions and minimal form fields help streamline the onboarding experience.
- Transparent Feature Communication:** Communicate the features available to users, especially those that are gated behind premium memberships or other restrictions. This ensures users understand the value proposition and can make informed decisions about upgrading.
- Intuitive Navigation:** Design the app with an intuitive navigation structure that makes it easy for users to find what they're looking for. Use clear labels and logical grouping to minimize confusion and frustration.
- Personalized Recommendations:** Incorporate personalization features to provide tailored recommendations and suggestions based on user preferences and behavior. This enhances the user experience by making interactions more relevant and engaging.
- Secure Payment Process:** Prioritize security in the app's payment process to instill trust and confidence in users. Implement robust encryption and authentication measures to protect users' sensitive information during transactions.
- Feedback Mechanisms:** Provide users with opportunities to provide feedback on their experience with the app. This can include in-app surveys, ratings, and reviews, as well as direct communication channels for reporting issues or suggesting improvements.

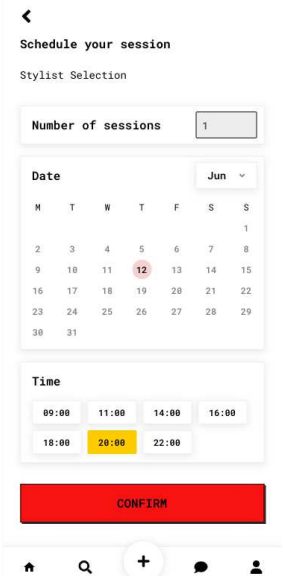
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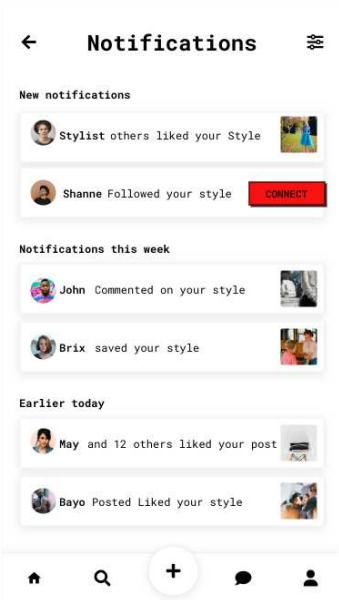
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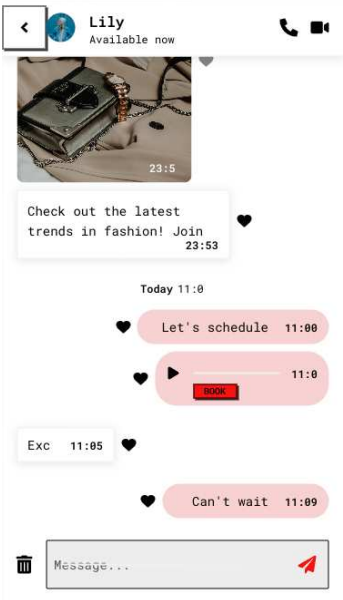
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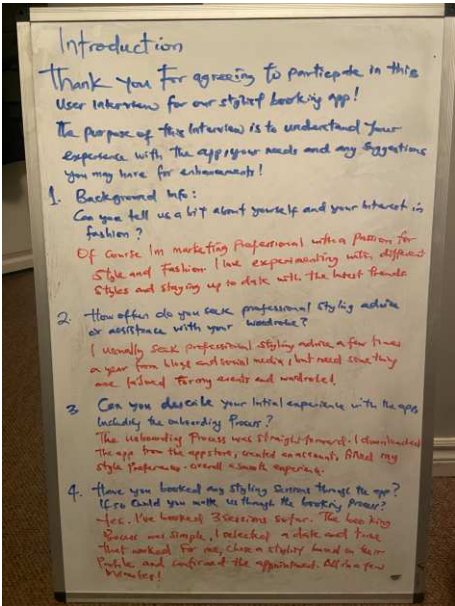
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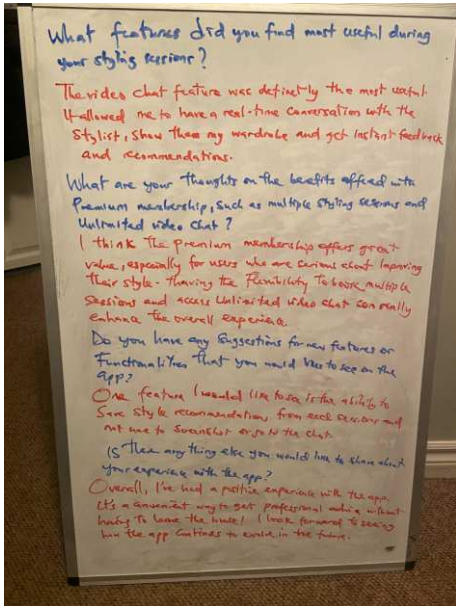
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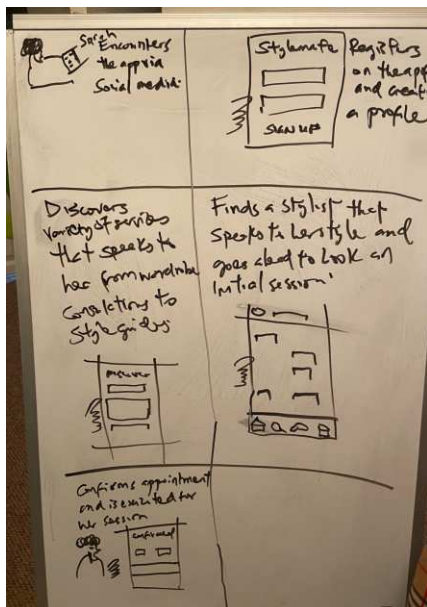
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StyleMate

Connect with Fashion Stylists & Explore Trends

Discover trends, book appointments, and get fashion tips.

● ● ● ●

LOG IN

SIGN UP

Continue as guest

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StyleMate — Fashion eCommerce App

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ROLE

UI/UX Designer

Tools: Figma · Maze · Hotjar · Adobe CC